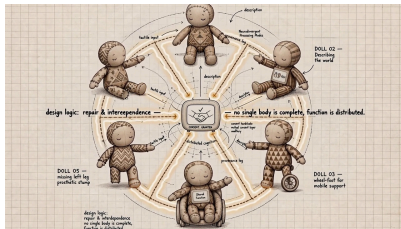


Sijuwade, Adekemi

62708870496



Wave Hill

2027 AnkhLave Garden Project Fellowship at Wave Hill

Adekemi Sijuwade
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 11a
 Brooklyn, NY 11201, United States
 347-740-7631
 kemiuka@gmail.com

Submitted: August 10, 2026

Forms

2027 AnkhLave Garden Fellowship Project at * indicates a required field Wave Hill

Please make sure to include all of the required materials listed below before submitting your final application. This includes: Artist Statement; Current Artist CV; Up to 10 work samples (images and/or videos); At least one professional reference. Thank you!

1.

How did you learn about the 2027 Van Lier Fellowship as part of the 9th Annual AnkhLave Garden Project at Wave Hill?

Instagram

2. Please indicate your preferred pronouns.

She her hers

3. Website:

If you have an artist Website, please include URL here.

<https://github.com/ukadike>, <https://github.com/ukadike/ijoya>

4. Please check to indicate your availability.

Participation in the 9th Annual AnkhLave Garden Project Fellowship at Wave Hill requires that artists spend at least three days a week in their Winter Workspace studios. Workspace studio hours are Monday - Sunday, 9 AM - 5 PM.

Winter Workspace Residency (February 23 – April 18, 2027)|Gyndor Terrace Garden Exhibition (May 8 – July 4, 2027)

5.

How do you identify yourself? Check all that apply. If none of the categories below apply, feel free to write how you identify in the blank space below.

Black (African, African American, Afro-Caribbean)

6. What motivates your work, ideas, process, concepts, use of materials?

250 words limit

I want to make a work about something I have had to learn in my own body: needing support is not the opposite of functioning. We function because we are connected.

Following a long period of paralysis, I learned movement as cooperation among bodies, technologies, surfaces, care, repetition, and time. A brace can do part of the work of a muscle. A cane changes the relationship between a body and the ground. Another person can give you the stability for one step.

Ìjòyà grows from that experience, but I do not want to make a medicalized work about disability or a story of heroic overcoming. I want to make something alive, strange, tender and joyful. We dance in the garden together because we cannot function alone.

Wave Hill feels right because a garden already understands this. Plants, soil, weather, walls, supports, gardeners, visitors and paths are constantly affecting one another. I want to learn from that system and make a sculpture that does not just represent interdependence, but actually has to practice it.

7.

If you have participated in artist residencies in the past, please describe your experience or give an example of the outcome of the residency.

250 words limit

My previous formal fellowship experience includes the Lincoln Center Digital Accessibility Fellowship and the Processing Foundation Teaching Fellowship. I have also worked as a mentor with the Processing Foundation.

These were fellowships and teaching experiences, not artist residencies, and I want to make that distinction clearly. My professional experience is separate: at Eyebeam, where I served as Head of Artist Initiatives and Inclusion, I worked closely with artists developing experimental technology. I learned what artists need while work is still becoming itself.

AnkhLave would give me something different: sustained residency time centered on my own physical artwork, with a specific site that can actively change the work. I have developed Ìjóyà's conceptual, accessibility, technological, and visual language. What I need now is concentrated time to prototype at scale, test materials and relationships, and move the project from studies into a resolved sculptural installation.

8.

How might you use the opportunity to participate in the Winter Workspace program?

250 words limit

I would use the Winter Workspace to figure out what these bodies actually need from one another.

I do not want to arrive with a finished sculpture and place it in the garden. I want the garden to change the work. Using observation methods I have been developing through Earth Sensors Lab, I will study wind, light, moisture, temperature, plant movement, existing supports, pathways, accessible routes, seated sightlines, and how people move through the site.

At the same time, I will prototype the bodies at increasing scale: testing textile skins,

flexible armatures, braided connections, cowrie-shaped tactile and signal nodes, pressure, vibration, tension, light and selective soft-robotic movement. I want to know what happens when one body senses something, but another body responds; when wind moves one form, and that movement changes the posture of another; when touch in one place can be felt somewhere else.

The drawings I have now are concept and maquette studies. The Workspace is where they become bodies. By the end of the period, I want the material, structural, and communication system resolved enough that the final human-scale and larger-than-human-scale installation can inhabit the garden as one distributed body.

9.

Please provide a description of your proposed sculpture for the group exhibition in Glyndor Terrace Garden at Wave Hill. Include working title, dimensions, media, and at least one image or concept sketch as one of your ten image samples provided below.

250 words limit

Title: Ìjòyà: Borrowed Function in the Garden

Dimensions: Site-responsive installation of approximately six human-scale to larger-than-human-scale bodies; final dimensions and spacing will be determined through Winter Workspace site study.

Media: Weather-resistant textile/mesh, soft sculptural volumes, flexible armatures, braided cord, mechanical connectors, tactile cowrie nodes, low-voltage light/vibration/sensing components and selective soft robotics.

Ìjòyà is a group of incomplete bodies that cannot fully function alone. One may sense but depend on another to respond. One may need tension from a neighboring body to remain upright. Movement, pressure, vibration, touch, and environmental signals can travel across the group.

The garden is part of that network. Wind may move one body and alter another. A visitor's touch may produce a response elsewhere. Cowrie forms operate as cultural and functional interfaces—eyes, tactile landmarks, signals and connection points—not decoration.

This is not a collection of robots in a garden. It is one distributed body expressed through multiple incomplete bodies. Their collective movement is the dance: we dance in the garden together because we cannot function alone.

10.

If you would like to provide any additional information about your application, please do so here.

250 words limit

Ìjòyà grows from a longer practice of asking how bodies, technologies and environments can support one another while recognizing that every body functions differently. During my graduate work at NYU ITP, I explored body-responsive interaction and accessible interfaces in projects including Moving lights and the Multi-modal Thumb Piano. That inquiry continued through my Digital Accessibility Fellowship at Lincoln Center, my teaching and mentoring with the Processing Foundation, and my professional work supporting artists and experimental technology at Eyebeam.

The current visual studies are applicant-directed concept and maquette studies; some use AI-assisted visual development and are identified as such in the work-sample captions. They are not photographs of completed sculptures. Their purpose is to communicate body relationships, material direction, access logic and possible construction systems before full-scale prototyping.

For Wave Hill, the forms will be developed at human scale and larger-than-human scale. The final visual language will remain handmade, tactile and materially legible: textile skins, visible seams and connections, earth-based tones, cowrie interface forms, differing bodies and capacities, and technology that remains subordinate to the sculptural relationship.

11. Please confirm your current address.

Enter your current address below, or indicate that the address on file in SlideRoom is correct.

105 Ashland Place, 11A. Brooklyn, Ny 11201

12. Please provide the contact details for at least one professional reference.

Name, title, email address, and phone number.

Adele Loye

Creative Technologist | WPP Production, MSc Digital Engineering Management

Phone: 718-625-3354

Email: adeleloye@gmail.com

ATTACHMENTS

Artist Statement

Attach a brief artist statement of no more than 300 words.



Adekemi_Sijuwade_Ukadike_Artist_Statement.pdf

Artist CV

Include information about your education; exhibition history, awards, grants and residencies; and details of any published writings, reviews or catalogues about your work.



Adekemi_Sijuwade_Ukadike_Wave_Hill_CV.pdf

Reference Contact List

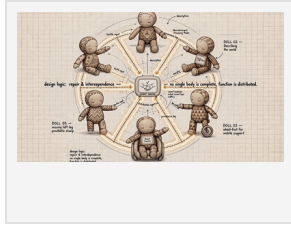
Please list the contact information of two references who could speak about your work and how the Fellowship would help you achieve your career goals.

*Note: This question previously asked to attach a reference letter. If you already have a letter from an art professional, professor or artist, please include it here. It would be helpful if your reference noted how the Fellowship would help you achieve your career goals. If your reference prefers to remain anonymous, please ask them to send the letter to visualarts@wavehill.org and write your name in the subject line. Otherwise, a reference list is all that is required. A letter is no longer necessary.



Adekemi_Sijuwade_Ukadike_Reference_Contact_List.pdf

PORTFOLIO



01_Distributed_Body_Visual_Language

Date: 8/10/26

Medium: image

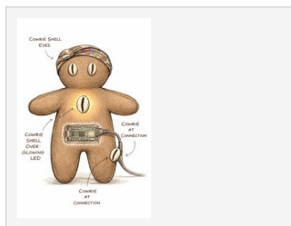
Dimensions:

Location, if applicable:

2026 · Concept study, digital drawing (AI-assisted visual development, artist-directed) · Dimensions variable

Visual-language study for Ìjòyà: Borrowed Function in the Garden. Stitched textile bodies with differing capacities and absences — one missing a leg, one with a wheel-foot, one seated — arranged around a shared connection point. Annotations map how tactile input, description, and support travel between bodies. Establishes the core principle: no single body is complete; function is distributed.

Concept study, not a fabricated work.



02_Cowrie_Tactile_Node_A

Date: 2026

Medium: image

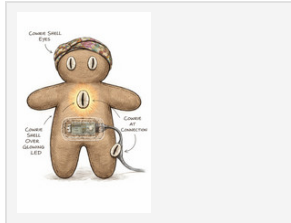
Dimensions:

Location, if applicable:

2026 · Concept study, digital drawing (AI-assisted visual development, artist-directed) · Dimensions variable

Construction study for the cowrie interface node.

Cowrie forms operate as functional and cultural interface elements — eyes, illuminated chest signal, tactile landmark, and connection point between bodies — with embedded low-voltage electronics visible beneath the textile skin. Cowries are interface, not decoration. Concept study, not a fabricated work.



03_Cowrie_Tactile_Node_B

Date: 2026

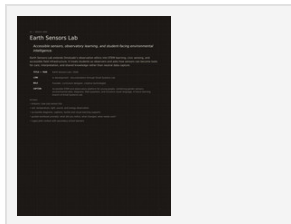
Medium: image

Dimensions:

Location, if applicable:

2026 · Concept study, digital drawing (AI-assisted visual development, artist-directed) · Dimensions variable

Second construction study extending the same interface language and soft-body direction, testing variation in seam, surface, and connection detail across differing bodies.



04_Earth_Sensors_Lab

Date: 2026

Medium: mixed

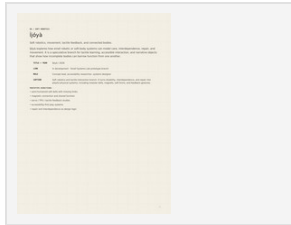
Dimensions:

Location, if applicable:

2026 · Ongoing project documentation · Small Systems Lab

Accessible environmental-observation and STEAM platform combining low-cost garden sensors, field questions, and tactile and visual learning supports. Provides the site-observation methodology

proposed for the Winter Workspace — studying wind, light, moisture, temperature, plant movement, and accessible routes. A distinct project from Ìjóyà; included as practice context.



📄 05_Soft_Robotics_Concept

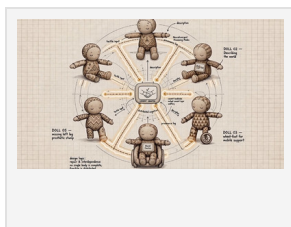
Date: 2026

Medium: Text

Dimensions:

Location, if applicable:

5. Ìjóyà: Soft Robotics Direction
2026 · Project documentation, Small Systems Lab
Overview of the Ìjóyà branch: soft robotics, tactile feedback, movement, and connected bodies.
Documents prototype directions including semi-humanoid soft forms with missing limbs, magnetic connection and shared function, servo and tactile-feedback studies, and repair and interdependence as design logic.



📄 Distributed_Body_animated

Date: 2026

Running time: 0.15

1920×1080, H.264, 24 fps, AAC audio, 14 MB.

Caption block:

Ìjóyà: Distributed Body Study (animated)
2026 · Video, 15 seconds · Concept study, digital animation (AI-assisted visual development, artist-directed)
Animated study of the distributed body. Signal moves between five incomplete bodies — tactile

input, description, and shared function traveling across the group rather than originating in any single form. Extends the still visual-language study into time, showing propagation as the mechanism of the dance. Concept study, not documentation of a fabricated work.